



MANUAL

How to use VolumeX

Everything from installing to fine-tuning. Most people only need the first three sections.

01 Install

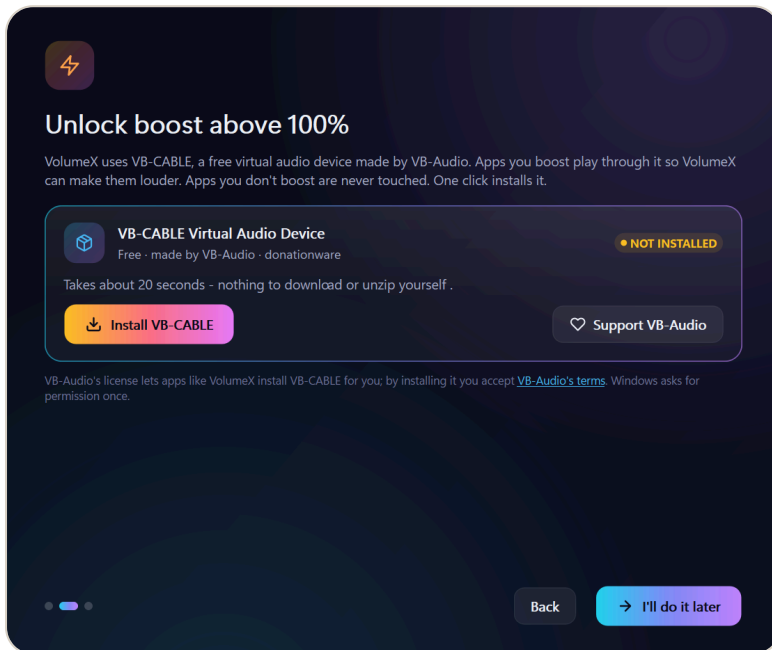
1. Download `VolumeX-Setup.exe`.
2. Run it. If Windows SmartScreen says it "protected your PC", choose *More info* → *Run anyway*. The installer isn't code-signed yet.
3. Follow the wizard. Keep *Install VB-CABLE by VB-Audio* ticked: it's what lets VolumeX go above 100%. You can also start VolumeX when you sign in and add a desktop shortcut.
4. If you kept VB-CABLE ticked, Windows asks for permission once while it's installed, and setup offers to restart your PC at the end. Say yes: VB-CABLE switches on after a restart.
5. VolumeX appears in the system tray. Click the  arrow near the clock if you don't see it.

Needs: Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit). VolumeX installs just for you, so it doesn't need administrator rights. Only VB-CABLE, a driver, asks for permission. Prefer no installer? Get the [portable zip](#), extract it anywhere and run `VolumeX.exe`. It can install VB-CABLE for you from its setup screen.

02 Unlock boost

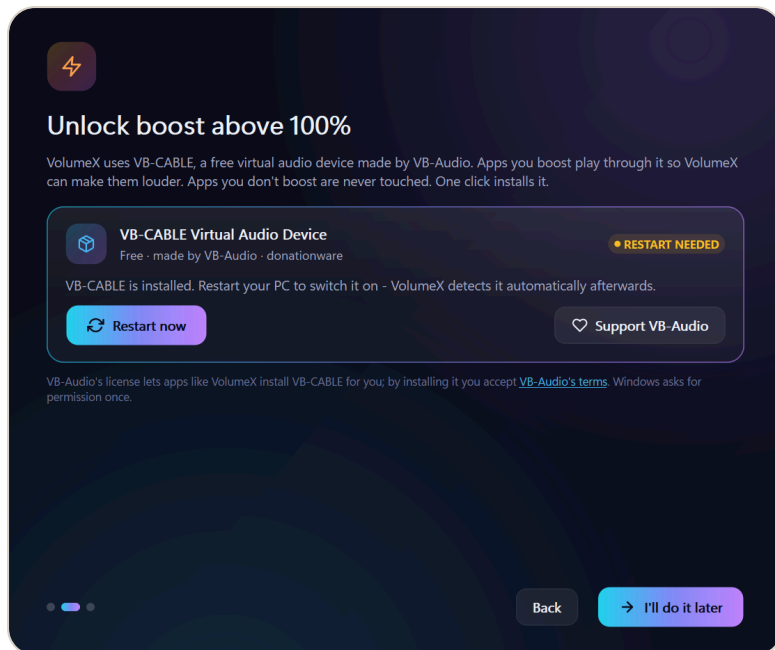
Windows won't set any volume above 100%. To go further, the sound itself has to be amplified. VolumeX does that with the help of **VB-CABLE**, a free virtual audio device made by VB-Audio. Only the apps you boost play through it. Everything else goes straight to your speakers, exactly as before.

The setup screen opens the first time you start VolumeX. The first page lets you try a boost slider. The second page installs VB-CABLE:



Unlock boost: one click installs VB-CABLE.

1. Click **Install VB-CABLE**. VolumeX checks that the package is genuinely signed by VB-Audio before running it.
2. Approve the Windows permission prompt. The install takes about 20 seconds.
3. When it says *Restart needed*, restart your PC, or click **Restart now**. VolumeX finds VB-CABLE by itself afterwards and the card turns green.



Installed: a restart switches it on.

Skipped it? VolumeX works as a smart mixer up to 100% until you're ready. The Mixer shows an **Unlock boost** banner that brings you back to this step, and so does *Settings → Troubleshooting → Run setup*.



Without VB-CABLE the boost zone past 100% is hatched, and the banner offers the one-click install.

No sound after installing VB-CABLE? Windows sometimes makes *CABLE Input* your default output, so everything plays into the cable and you hear nothing. VolumeX notices and shows **All sound is going into VB-CABLE**: click **Fix it** to switch Windows back to your speakers or headphones.



If the automatic install fails, the card offers **Open VB-CABLE setup**, VB-Audio's own installer. Click *Install Driver* there, then restart.

About VB-CABLE: VB-CABLE is donationware by VB-Audio. VolumeX ships their official, unmodified package, which VB-Audio's licence allows. If it's useful to you, please support VB-Audio.

03 The mixer

The Mixer is VolumeX's main screen: the master dial on the left, and every app that's making sound on the right.



Chrome boosted to 220%, Discord to 135%, Spotify turned down to 45%.

The master dial

- **0 to 100%** is your normal Windows volume, the same one the taskbar and your keyboard's volume keys change.
- **Above 100%** boosts every app at once. The number turns warm and a *BOOST* label shows how many decibels you've added.
- Drag around the dial, scroll over it, or use the quick presets underneath: **100%**, **150%**, **200%** and the maximum.
- *Output* shows what's playing. When the Distortion Guard is working, it says *GUARD ACTIVE* and how much it's holding back.



Master at 150%: every app is 1.5 times louder.

App rows

Each app has its icon, its name and status, a slider, the current level, a **mute** button and a **remember** (bookmark) button. Apps show up as soon as they make a sound. Browsers with many processes appear as one app.

The slider's notch marks 100%. Left of it is normal volume, drawn in cool colours. Right of it is the boost zone, drawn in warm colours. The bright part inside the slider is a live meter of what the app is playing.

DO THIS	TO
Drag	Set any level. The slider snaps to 100% as you pass it.
Scroll wheel	Change by 2%. Hold <code>Ctrl</code> for 10%.
← →	Change by 1% (click the slider first).
<code>PgUp</code> <code>PgDn</code>	Change by 10%.
<code>Home</code> <code>End</code>	Jump to 0% or to the maximum.
Double-click	Back to 100%.

What the status means

STATUS	MEANING
Playing / Idle	The app is or isn't making sound right now.
BOOSTED	The app is above 100% and playing through the boost engine.
Ready to boost	It's set above 100% and will be boosted as soon as it plays.
Restart app to boost	The app didn't switch to the boost path while it was running. Close and reopen it once. Until then it plays at up to 100%.
Setup needed	VB-CABLE isn't installed yet. See Unlock boost .
Boost paused	You've turned <i>Boost</i> off, so everything plays at up to 100%.
Muted	You muted the app with its speaker button.



Chrome boosted, Spotify waiting for a restart, Discord muted.

Boost and the Distortion Guard

- **Boost** turns all boosting on or off. Off puts every app back at 100% or below, straight away, without forgetting your settings.
- **Distortion Guard** is a look-ahead limiter. It catches peaks a few milliseconds before they would clip, so boosted audio stays clean. Leave it on.



You're boosting above 100%

Boosted audio can get very loud, especially on headphones. Raise it slowly and keep it at a comfortable level - long exposure to loud sound can harm your hearing.

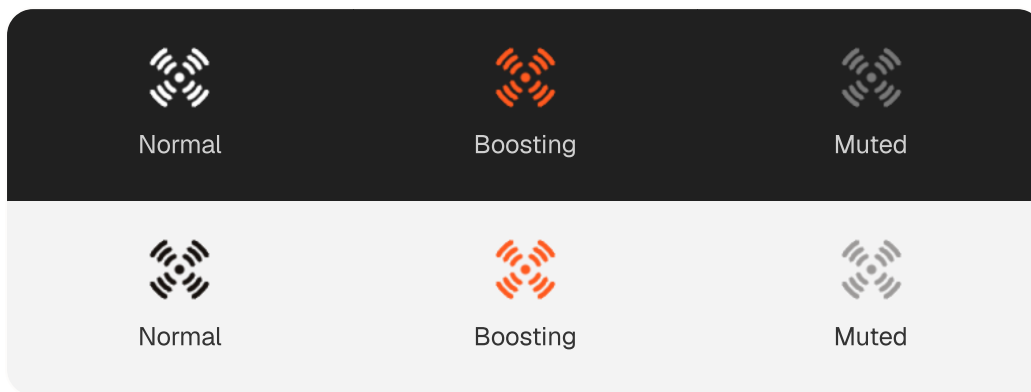
The Distortion Guard keeps boosted sound clean, but it can't make it quieter.

Got it

The first time you boost, VolumeX reminds you to go easy on your ears.

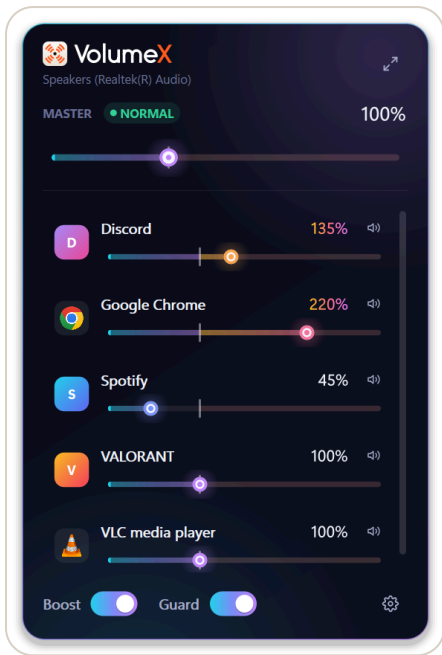
04 Tray & hotkeys

VolumeX lives in the system tray. Closing its window keeps it running there, so your levels keep working.



ICON	MEANING
White or dark glyph	Normal. The glyph matches your taskbar's light or dark theme.
Orange glyph	Something is being boosted right now.
Faded glyph	Your output device is muted.

- **Click** the icon for the quick mixer: the master slider, the apps that are playing, and Boost and Guard switches.
- **Double-click** to open the main window.
- **Right-click** for *Open VolumeX*, *Pause boost*, *Reset audio*, *Settings* and *Quit VolumeX*.



The quick mixer that opens from the tray.

Hotkeys

These work from any app:

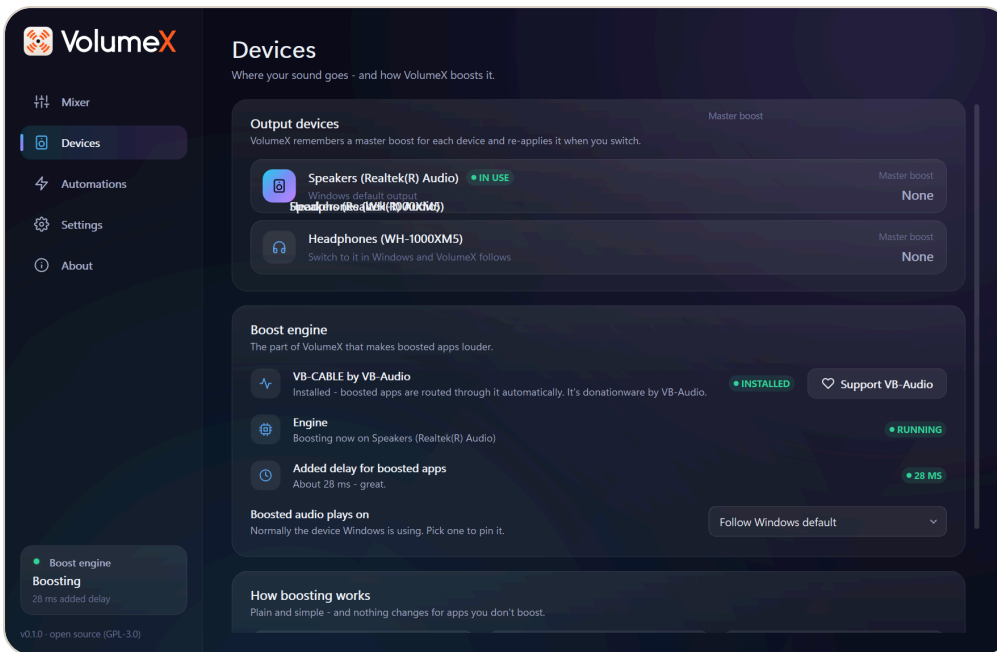
KEYS	ACTION
Ctrl Alt ↑	Boost the app you're using by 10%.
Ctrl Alt ↓	Turn the app you're using down by 10%.
Ctrl Alt 0	Reset the app you're using to 100%.
Ctrl Alt PgUp	Master up by 10%.
Ctrl Alt PgDn	Master down by 10%.
Ctrl Alt B	Pause or resume all boost.

A small overlay near the bottom of the screen shows the new level. You can turn it off in Settings.



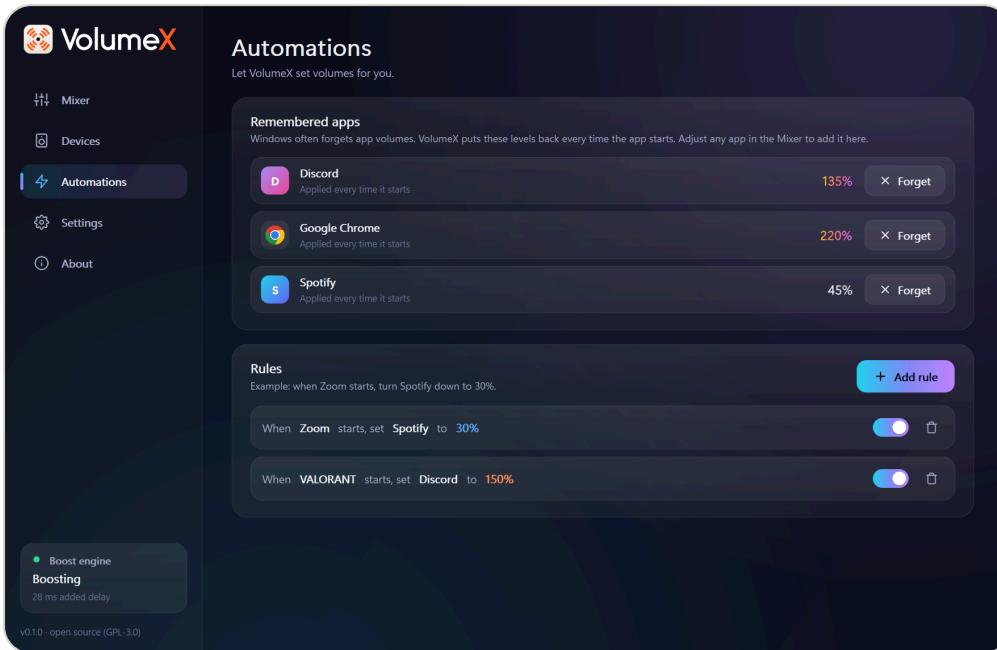
To change a shortcut, go to *Settings* → *Hotkeys*, click it and press the new combination. It needs **Ctrl**, **Alt** or **Win**. **Backspace** clears it and **Esc** cancels. A shortcut shown in amber is already taken by another program.

05 Devices



- **Output devices:** VolumeX follows whichever device Windows is using. It remembers the master boost for each one, so your headphones can sit at 180% while your speakers stay at 100%. Switch devices in Windows and VolumeX applies the right boost.
- **VB-CABLE by VB-Audio:** whether it's installed, with an *Install* button if not, and a link to support VB-Audio if it is.
- **Engine:** *Ready* means it's waiting and starts by itself when you boost something. *Boosting* means it's working.
- **Added delay for boosted apps:** usually 20–45 ms. Apps you don't boost get no delay at all.
- **Boosted audio plays on:** normally *Follow Windows default*. Pick a device to always send boosted audio there.

06 Automations



Remembered apps

Windows often forgets per-app volumes. VolumeX remembers any app you adjust and puts its level back every time it starts. The bookmark button on each app row turns this on or off. **Forget** removes an app here.

Rules

A rule changes one app's volume when another app starts. For example: *when Zoom starts, set Spotify to 30%.*

1. Click **Add rule**.
2. Choose the app that triggers it, the app to change, and the level.
3. Click **Add rule**. Use its switch to pause it, or the bin to delete it.

New rule

Change one app's volume automatically whenever another app starts.

When this app starts

Discord

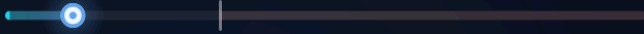


set this app

Google Chrome



to this level



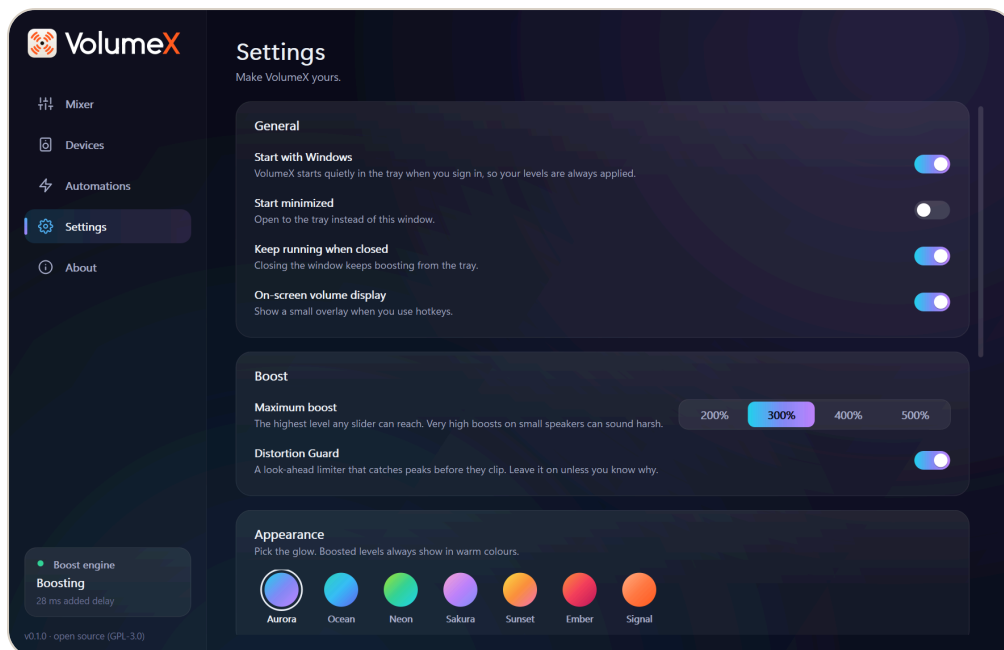
30%

Cancel

✓ Add rule

07 Settings

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Start with Windows	Starts VolumeX quietly in the tray when you sign in, so your levels are always applied.
Start minimized	Opens to the tray instead of the window.
Keep running when closed	Closing the window keeps VolumeX in the tray. Quit from the tray menu.
On-screen volume display	Shows the overlay when you use hotkeys.
Maximum boost	The highest level any slider can reach: 200%, 300% (default), 400% or 500%.
Distortion Guard	The look-ahead limiter. Keep it on unless you know why not.
Appearance	Seven colour themes. Boosted levels always show in warm colours.
Hotkeys	Change or clear any shortcut. See Tray & hotkeys .
User manual	Opens this manual.
Reset audio	Every app back to 100% and boost off, in one click. Use it if anything sounds wrong.
Boost setup	Opens the VB-CABLE setup again.
Log files	Opens the log folder, which is useful when reporting a problem.



The **About** page shows the version, links to this manual, the website and the source code, a way to send feedback, and the credits, including a link to support VB-Audio.

08 Troubleshooting

I hear nothing after installing VB-CABLE

Windows has probably made *CABLE Input* your default output. Click **Fix it** on the banner in the Mixer. You can also go to Windows Settings → System → Sound → Output and choose your speakers or headphones.

An app says "Restart app to boost"

Some apps, Spotify for example, only pick up a new audio path when they start. Close the app and open it again, and it's boosted from then on. If the app has its own output-device setting, set it to *Default*.

A game or music program can't be boosted

Apps that use *exclusive mode* audio, some games and pro audio tools, bypass the Windows mixer entirely, so no mixer can boost them. The same goes for apps set to one fixed output device in their own settings. Switch the app to shared mode or *Default* device if it has that option.

Boosted audio is slightly behind the picture

Boosted apps get about 20-45 ms of delay, which is usually unnoticeable in video. For competitive games, keep the game at 100% or below: it then plays directly with no added delay.

Boosted sound is harsh or crackly

Make sure the Distortion Guard is on (Mixer or Settings). Very high boosts can still sound harsh on small laptop speakers. Try a lower level, or lower *Settings* → *Maximum boost*.

It still says "Setup needed" after I installed VB-CABLE

Restart your PC: VB-CABLE switches on after a restart. If it's still missing, open *Settings* → *Troubleshooting* → *Run setup* and install again, or use *Open VB-CABLE setup*.

The Boost engine shows "Problem"

Usually your output device was unplugged or changed while something was boosted. VolumeX retries by itself. Choosing another output in Windows also restarts it. Apps keep playing at up to 100% in the meantime.

A hotkey doesn't work

Another program may already use that combination. It's shown in amber in *Settings* → *Hotkeys*. Pick a different one.

Something just sounds wrong

Use **Reset audio** from the tray menu or *Settings* → *Troubleshooting*. Every app goes back to 100% and boosting turns off. Nothing is deleted, and you can boost again straight away.

09 Privacy & safety

- **No network, no telemetry, no account.** The one exception: if you ask VolumeX to install VB-CABLE and the copy that ships with it is missing, it downloads VB-Audio's official package from vb-audio.com and verifies its signature first.
- **No code injection.** VolumeX never touches other programs' memory, so it's safe to run alongside games with anti-cheat.
- **Always undoable.** Every change VolumeX makes to Windows audio is written to a journal first, and undone when you quit, if VolumeX crashes, and when you uninstall.
- **Gentle on ears.** Levels ramp smoothly instead of jumping, the Distortion Guard is on by default, and the first boost comes with a hearing note.

Settings are stored in `%APPDATA%\VolumeX\settings.json`. Logs and the journal are in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\VolumeX`. The code is open source: github.com/SihabSahariar/VolumeX.

10 Uninstall

Go to Windows Settings → Apps → Installed apps → VolumeX → Uninstall. The uninstaller first sends every app VolumeX boosted back to your normal device, then removes VolumeX and its start-up entry. If VolumeX installed VB-CABLE, it asks whether to remove that too. Choose *No* if other apps use it.

If an app VolumeX was boosting is closed while you uninstall, Windows only lets VolumeX reset it by clearing *all* per-app output choices. That includes any you set yourself in Windows Settings → Sound → Volume mixer.

Using the portable zip? Quit VolumeX from the tray, run `VolumeX.exe --restore` once, then delete the folder.